DReSA contributor guide

Version 1.0, 21 October 2026. Australian Research Data Commons (ARDC). https://dresa.org.au

This guide is for organisations that list training on DReSA, by hand or through an automated feed. It lists every field DReSA reads, the terms it accepts, and what changed when DReSA moved to the current version of TeSS in September 2026.

At a glance

There are three ways to get your events and materials into DReSA. Most partners with more than a handful of listings use a feed.

Method	Best for	Effort to set up	How often DReSA updates
Add by hand (sign in, then **New event** or **New material**)	A few listings a year	None	When you save
Automated feed (a CSV file, iCal calendar, Eventbrite, Zenodo community, web pages with Bioschemas markup, or another TeSS site)	Regular events or a catalogue of materials	Once, about an hour	Every night
JSON API (your own code posts to DReSA)	Developers with their own system	Some programming	When your code runs

If you are unsure, start with a CSV feed: a spreadsheet saved as CSV at a web address that does not change, such as a file in a public GitHub repository. Templates: event CSV template and material CSV template.

Event fields

An event needs eight fields filled, or DReSA refuses it: Title, URL, Description, Timezone, Contact, Organizer, Eligibility and Host Institutions. Start and End are not refused when blank, but an event without dates will not show in upcoming listings, so always fill them.

Column headings must match the template exactly (capitals and spaces included). Where a column takes several values, separate them with semicolons or commas.

Column	Required	What to put in it	Example
Title	Yes	Name of the event	Introduction to R for researchers
URL	Yes	Full web address of the event page, starting with https://	https://example.edu.au/events/intro-r
Description	Yes	A paragraph or two. Plain text or Markdown	A hands-on half-day workshop...
Start	Strongly advised	Date and time, as YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM	2026-11-03 10:00
End	Strongly advised	As for Start	2026-11-03 13:00
Timezone	Yes	A time zone name	Australia/Sydney
Contact	Yes	An email address or contact page for enquiries	training@example.edu.au
Organizer	Yes	Who runs the event. **Organiser** (Australian spelling) is also accepted	Example University Library
Eligibility	Yes	One or more of the eligibility codes in *Allowed terms*	open_to_all

Host Institutions	Yes	The institutions hosting it. **Host Institution** (singular) is also accepted	Example University
Online	No, but advised	Whether people attend online, in person or both (see *Allowed terms*)	online
City	No	Town or city of an in-person event	Brisbane
Country	No	Country	Australia
Venue	No	Building and room	Library, Level 2, Room 201
Postcode	No	Postcode	4072
Subtitle	No	A short second line under the title	Part 1 of 3
Duration	No	Free text	3 hours
Recognition	No	Any certificate or credit	Certificate of attendance
Types	No	One or more event type codes (see *Allowed terms*)	workshop
Cost Basis	No	One cost code (see *Allowed terms*)	free
Currency	No	Three-letter currency code	AUD
Cost	No	A number, no currency sign	50
Capacity	No	Number of places	30
Fields	No	Research fields, separated by semicolons	Health sciences; Ecology
Keywords	No	Keywords, separated by semicolons	R; data analysis; statistics
Audiences	No	Who it is for, separated by semicolons	PhD students; early career researchers
Objectives	No	What people will learn	Import, clean and plot data in R
Prerequisites	No	What people need to know first	None
Requirements	No	Software or equipment to bring	A laptop with R and RStudio installed

DReSA recognises an event it has seen before by its URL. Give every event (and every session of a series) its own stable URL, and do not reuse a URL for a new event.

Material fields

A material needs seven fields filled, or DReSA refuses it: Title, URL, Description, Keywords, Contact, Licence and Status. Licence must name an actual licence; a blank licence or "notspecified" is refused. A material can have at most 20 keywords.

A material feed can also be a Google Sheet: share it so anyone with the link can view, and give us its normal address.

Column	Required	What to put in it	Example
Title	Yes	Name of the material	Data management planning: a short course
URL	Yes	Full web address of the material, starting with https://	https://example.edu.au/courses/dmp
Description	Yes	A paragraph or two. Plain text or Markdown	A self-paced course covering...
Keywords	Yes	Up to 20, separated by semicolons	data management; DMP; FAIR

Contact	Yes	An email address or contact page	training@example.edu.au
Licence	Yes	A licence code from *Allowed terms*	CC-BY-4.0
Status	Yes	active, development or archived	active
Authors	No	Names, separated by semicolons	A. Researcher; B. Librarian
Contributors	No	Names, separated by semicolons	C. Developer
DOI	No	The DOI, if the material has one	10.5281/zenodo.1234567
Version	No	Version number or label	1.2
Published	No	Date first published, as YYYY-MM-DD	2025-03-01
Modified	No	Date last changed, as YYYY-MM-DD	2026-08-15
Competency	No	One difficulty level from *Allowed terms*	beginner
Fields	No	Research fields, separated by semicolons	Social sciences
Audiences	No	Who it is for, separated by semicolons	Research support staff
Types	No	Resource type codes from *Allowed terms*, separated by semicolons	full-course; video
Other Types	No	Free text. Required when Types includes other	Podcast series
Objectives	No	What people will learn	Write a data management plan
Prerequisites	No	What people need to know first	None
Syllabus	No	Outline of the content	Module 1: Why plan...

As with events, DReSA recognises a material it has seen before by its URL.

Allowed terms

Where a column takes a controlled term, put the **code** in your file, not the label. Codes are lower case unless shown otherwise. An unknown eligibility or event type code causes the whole event to be refused.

Column	Code	Shown on DReSA as
Eligibility (events)	open_to_all	Open to all
	host_institution	Host institutions (only staff, students or users of the hosts)
	expression_of_interest	Expression of interest
	by_invitation	By invitation
Types (events)	webinar	Webinar
	workshop	Workshop
	conference	Conference
	meeting	Meeting
	hackathon	Hackathon
	dropin	Drop-in session or hackyhour
Online (events)	online, or TRUE, Yes, 1	Online
	onsite, or FALSE, No, 0, in-person	In person
	hybrid	Hybrid

Cost Basis (events)	free	Free to all
	hosts	Cost to non-members
	charge	Cost incurred by all
Status (materials)	active	Active
	development	Under development
	archived	Archived
Competency (materials)	notspecified, awareness, beginner, intermediate, advanced	The same words, capitalised

Material Types (codes): activity, assessment, case-study, full-course, game, guide, handout, infographic, interactive, lecture, lesson, lesson-plan, module, presentation, quiz, reading, rubric, simulation, strategy, syllabus, tutorial, unit, video, other.

Licence (materials): DReSA accepts 115 licence codes, written as standard SPDX identifiers. The common ones are CC-BY-4.0, CC-BY-SA-4.0, CC-BY-NC-4.0, CC-BY-NC-SA-4.0, CC-BY-ND-4.0, CC-BY-NC-ND-4.0, CC0-1.0, MIT, Apache-2.0, GPL-3.0, BSD-3-Clause, and Reserved (all rights reserved). The full list is the Licence menu on the **New material** form.

Setting up a feed

Send us the address of your feed and we register it against your organisation; DReSA then collects it every night at 3 am Australian Eastern time (17:00 UTC).

Feed type	What we need from you
CSV file (events or materials)	A web address that always returns the latest file, such as the "raw" link to a file in a public GitHub repository
Google Sheet (materials)	The sheet's address, shared so anyone with the link can view
iCal calendar (events)	The calendar's public .ics address
Eventbrite (events)	Your Eventbrite organisation page
Zenodo community (materials)	The community's address
Web pages with Bioschemas markup	The page or sitemap address. You can register this one yourself: sign in, open your organisation's page, choose the **Sources** tab and add the address. An administrator approves it before it runs
Another TeSS site	The site's address and your organisation's name there

How updates work:

- **New rows** become new listings the next morning.
- **Changed rows** update the matching listing, matched by URL. If you change a URL, DReSA treats it as a new listing and the old one stays.
- **Removed rows** are not deleted from DReSA. Past events simply drop out of upcoming listings. To withdraw a future event or a material, sign in and delete it, or ask us.
- **Refused rows** are skipped and the rest of the feed still loads. We can send you the reasons, row by row.

Each feed run is recorded on your source's page on DReSA, with how many rows were read, written and refused. Partners with an account linked to their organisation can see it there.

API for developers

DReSA's API follows the JSON:API standard; the full reference is at dresa.org.au/api/json_api. Reading is open to anyone. Creating or changing records needs a DReSA account linked to your organisation and the API token shown on your profile page; keep the token private.

What	Address
Events	https://dresa.org.au/events.json
Materials	https://dresa.org.au/materials.json
Collections (formerly packages)	https://dresa.org.au/collections.json
Content providers (organisations)	https://dresa.org.au/content_providers.json
Trainers	https://dresa.org.au/trainers.json
Older API reference	dresa.org.au/api/legacy

Any listing page also works as an API call: add the same filters you see in the browser address bar, for example `events.json?keywords=R`.

Rate limits. DReSA is a small service shared by everyone. Make no more than one request a second from one address, and fewer on search and listing pages. Faster callers receive HTTP status 429 ("too many requests"); wait a minute before trying again. For a nightly sync, one request every two seconds is plenty. If you need more, ask us first.

The developers page also describes widgets that show your DReSA events on your own website.

What changed from the old DReSA

If your feed worked before September 2026, it should work now without changes: the CSV column headings and the vocabulary codes are the same. The differences are below.

Old DReSA	Current DReSA	What you need to do
Packages, at /packages and /packages.json	Collections, at /collections and /collections.json. The old address now returns "not found"	Update any code or links that use /packages
Online column read as true or false only	Online also accepts TRUE/FALSE in any case, Yes/No, 1/0, and the words online, onsite and hybrid. Hybrid is new	Nothing; use hybrid where it fits
Start and End required	Not refused when blank, but undated events do not appear in upcoming listings	Keep filling them
City and Country required for in-person events	Optional	Still advised, so people can search by place
Organizer and Host Institutions headings only	Organiser and Host Institution (singular) also accepted	Nothing
Eventbrite and other feeds set up by the old team	The same feeds, moved to the new system in October 2026	Check your listings look current (see *Getting help*)
Eligibility, event types, difficulty, status, cost basis and licence codes	Unchanged	Nothing

Free-text eligibility such as "NCI Users"	Refused, as before: eligibility must be one of the four codes	Use host_institution for events limited to your own users (for example "NCI Users" becomes host_institution); use by_invitation only where people must be personally invited
The .json addresses	The same .json addresses, plus a documented JSON:API at /api/json_api	Use the JSON:API reference for new work

Getting help

To check your listings, open your organisation's page from Providers: it shows your upcoming events and materials. If something is missing the morning after you added it to your feed, it was probably refused; ask us for the reasons.

For	Contact
Setting up or changing a feed, refused rows, API access	Rob Clemens, ARDC, through the DReSA contact form
Linking your DReSA account to your organisation	The same contact form; tell us your organisation's name
More on adding listings by hand	Registering on DReSA and the DReSA User Manual

This guide describes DReSA as at 21 October 2026. Field names may be aligned with other TeSS sites in future; any change will be announced to contributors first.